

that Android has such a huge base in India, we are waiting for the right time to launch the Firefox-based smartphones here,” he said. But is the Firefox OS really a ‘deal-breaker’ for customers? “The Firefox OS can be at par with Android. The major advantages of Mozilla Firefox are primarily the memory factor and the space that it takes—the entire OS as well as the applications. It’s not basically an API kind of OS; it’s an installation directly coming from HTML. That’s a major advantage. Also, apps for the OS are built using HTML5, which means that, in theory, they run on the Web and on your phone or tablet. What made Android jump from Jelly Bean to KitKat (which requires low memory) is the fact that the end user is looking at a low memory OS. Mozilla Firefox is also easy to use. I won’t say ‘better’ or ‘any less’, but at par with Android,” said Garg, evidently confident of the platform.

To take things forward, vis-à-vis the platform, Alcatel One Touch is also planning to come up with an exclusive App Store, with its own set of apps. “We have already planned our ‘play store’, and tied up with a number of developers to build our own apps. I cannot comment on the timeline of the app store but it’s in the pipeline. We currently have as many as five R&D centres in China. We are not yet in India, although we are looking to engage developers here as well. We’re already in the discussion phase on that front,” said Garg. So, what’s the company’s strategy to engage developers in particular? “We invite developers to come up and give in their

ideas. Then either we accept them, which means we buy the idea, or we work out some kind of association with which developers get revenue out of the collaboration. In China, more than 100,000 developers are engaged in building apps for Alcatel. India is on our to-do list for building a community of app developers. It’s currently at an ‘amateur stage’; however, we expect things to happen eventually,” he said.

Although there’s no definite time period for the launch

of Alcatel’s One Touch Firefox OS-based smartphone in India (Garg is confident it will be here by the end of 2014, followed by a whole series, depending upon how it’s received), one thing that is certain is that the device will be very affordable. Cutting costs while developing such low-end devices is certainly a challenge for companies, since customers do tend to choose ‘value for money’ when making their purchases. “We are not allowed to do any ‘trimming’ with respect to the hardware quality—since we are FCC-compliant, we cannot compromise on that,” said Garg.

So what do companies like Alcatel One Touch actually do to cut manufacturing costs? “We look at larger quantities that we can sell at a low cost, using competitive chipsets that are offered at a low price. On the hardware side, we may not give lamination in a low-cost phone, or we may not offer Corning glass or an IPS, and instead give a TFT, for instance,” Garg added. **END** 

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June 2014	Open Source on Windows	Mobile Apps	UTMs fo SMEs
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August 2014	Kernel Development	Big Data solution Providers	SSDs for Servers
September 2014	Open Source for Start-ups	Cloud	Android Devices
October 2014	Mobile App Development	Training on Programming Languages	Projectors
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